

James Roberts

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SUMMARY

Infrastructure and Platform Engineering professional with more than 20 years of experience designing, supporting and improving enterprise IT services across financial services, local government and managed service environments.

My experience combines strong technical capability with project delivery, stakeholder engagement and technical leadership. Throughout my career I have successfully led infrastructure migrations, disaster recovery exercises, operational improvements, service transitions and monitoring initiatives while maintaining a strong focus on operational resilience and customer service.

Alongside my commercial experience, I have designed and continue to develop a comprehensive engineering homelab, demonstrating practical skills in Docker, Kubernetes, Linux, cloud technologies, monitoring, automation and modern infrastructure engineering.

I enjoy solving complex technical problems, mentoring colleagues and delivering improvements that provide long-term value to both technical teams and the wider business.

EDUCATION

University of Central Lancashire

HND Computer Studies (Year 1)

Preston College

BTEC Information Technology

GCSEs including English and Mathematics

EXPERIENCE

Third Line Product Support Engineer

September 2025 – Present

Appello Group

- Technical escalation point for complex incidents and service requests.
- Provided customer-facing technical support for critical services.
- Mentored first and second-line engineers.
- Technically led a nationwide DrayTek SIM upgrade programme.
- Designed and delivered a Grafana monitoring proof of concept.
- Worked closely with engineering and development teams to improve service quality and operational visibility.

Infrastructure Manager

January 2025 – June 2025

Yunex Traffic

- Led infrastructure support activities across enterprise and cloud environments.
- Supported AWS-based infrastructure and operational services.
- Improved monitoring, automation and deployment processes.
- Worked with development, security and compliance teams.
- Focused on availability, resilience and continual improvement.

Technical Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery Manager

September 2020 – December 2024

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- Planned and coordinated enterprise disaster recovery testing.
- Worked with infrastructure, application and business teams to deliver successful recovery exercises.
- Managed technical dependencies, recovery sequencing and stakeholder communication.

- Produced post-exercise reports and improvement plans.
- Contributed to operational resilience strategy and governance.

Technical Operations Analyst (UNIX)

April 2012 – September 2020

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- Supported enterprise UNIX infrastructure in a highly available environment.
- Led the transition of operational activities to an offshore provider.
- Coordinated documentation, knowledge transfer and service readiness.
- Technically supported a major data centre migration programme.
- Improved operational procedures and service delivery.

Level 2 IT Consultant

January 2008 – April 2012

Hampshire County Council

- Migrated Solaris infrastructure to IBM AIX.
- Implemented and supported Red Hat Enterprise Linux.
- Installed and maintained IBM Content Manager, DB2 and Tivoli.
- Participated in disaster recovery testing and operational support.
- Provided technical support within a 24/7 enterprise environment.

IT Support Engineer

1998 – 2008

RIAS plc / JRL plc

Progressed from Help Desk to Third Line Support, gaining extensive experience across infrastructure, enterprise systems, UNIX/Linux platforms, Microsoft technologies and customer support.

PROJECTS

Disaster Recovery & Operational Resilience | Planned and coordinated large-scale disaster recovery exercises, bringing together multiple technical teams to validate recovery procedures, identify risks and improve organisational resilience.

Offshore Service Transition | Led the technical transition of infrastructure operations to an offshore support provider, overcoming technical, cultural and communication challenges while improving operational consistency and reducing dependency on individual specialists.

Infrastructure Separation Programme | Supported the separation of a shared enterprise infrastructure, coordinating suppliers, stakeholders and internal teams to enable two organisations to operate independently while maintaining service continuity.

Technical Leadership | Provided technical leadership across infrastructure upgrades, operational improvements and monitoring initiatives while mentoring engineers and acting as a senior technical escalation point.

Modern Engineering Homelab | Designed and maintain a production-style engineering platform featuring Docker, Kubernetes, Prometheus, Grafana, CrowdSec, reverse proxy, authentication, monitoring, automation and observability. The platform is fully documented within my online engineering portfolio and demonstrates my commitment to continuous professional development.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Linux (Red Hat, Debian, Ubuntu)

UNIX Administration

VMware

Enterprise Infrastructure

Networking

Storage

High Availability

Disaster Recovery

Operational Resilience

Docker & Docker Compose

Kubernetes (K3s)
AWS
Microsoft Azure
Infrastructure as Code
Git & GitHub
CI/CD
Platform Engineering
Grafana
Prometheus
Loki
Promtail
CrowdSec
Node Exporter
cAdvisor
Nginx Proxy Manager
Authelia
Technical Leadership
Project Delivery
Stakeholder Management
Supplier Management
Risk Management
Service Transition
Change Management
Mentoring
ITIL

CERTIFICATIONS

RHCE – Red Hat Certified Engineer (Certification No. 804005459617933)

PERSONAL INTERESTS

Outside work I enjoy Salsa and Modern Jive dancing with my wife, including travelling to Cuba to learn Salsa, spending time sea fishing, exploring different cultures through travel, and continually expanding my engineering homelab through practical projects. One of my favourite personal projects has been building a BirdNET wildlife monitoring platform to identify birds visiting our garden using Linux, Docker, machine learning and Grafana.

REFERENCES

Available on request.